



Parking spot saver

Google Maps will help you remember where you park your car.
<http://dgit.in/GMapsCar>



Sony Xperia L1

Xperia L1 is a new budget-friendly smartphone, available in three colours.
<http://dgit.in/SXperiaL1>

Space Age



The entire solar system spans lesser than the distance between the Sun and Mercury

upon first impressions, the TRAPPIST-1 system could not have been more ideal in mankind's galactic colonisation plans.

Are we asking the right questions?

Every wrong question asked would mean that somewhere, a right question remained unanswered. It's true that the TRAPPIST-1 discovery is indeed unique in nature, and no such systems have been discovered before. It is also important to consider complex details before simply being fascinated by the details of the latest system.

Should we really be asking whether there is life on these planets, or should we first look into the finer details that may prohibit life, and move ahead accordingly? Space research is expensive, without having given much concrete outcome to significantly alter the course of life. As such it is important for us to know that we need to ask the right questions, and choose them very carefully.

Alongside this lies the all-important discussion on how will extraterrestrial life actually look like, if we actually stumble upon it in the future? Are we narrowed down upon our perception of life and life forms in order to discover what is unknown? Even if we do find life somewhere outside our Solar system, how would we communicate? Would it lead to any good, or are we hunting down our own nemesis?

The TRAPPIST-1 system is being seen as an optimistic ground for re-searching on extraterrestrial life, and

answering a lot of questions for which mankind has been searching answers.

Extraterrestrials; Fermi Paradox

The prospect of discovering extraterrestrial life in TRAPPIST-1 brings us back to the Fermi paradox. It states the contradictions presented by high probability estimates and clear lack of evidences in our hunt for intelligent life forms.

The Fermi paradox states the clear observation of billions of stars in the universe, along with the probability that a few billions of them are similar to the Sun in terms of composition. This further generates very high probability that at least a few millions of the Sun-like stars

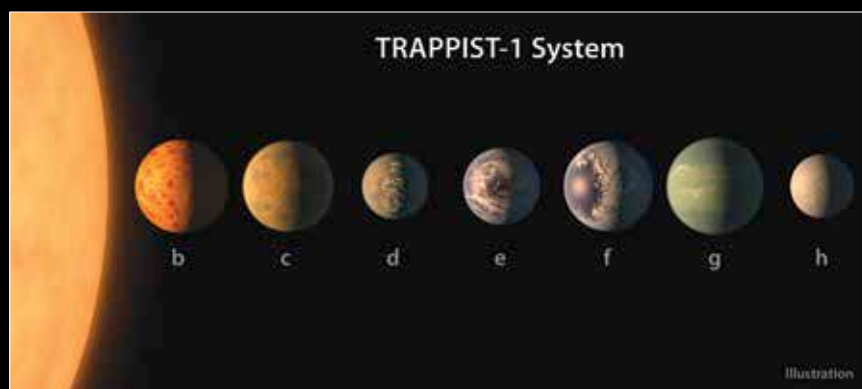
ing systems, and leave TRAPPIST-1 with the prospect of being able to support life, subject to further discoveries. The Fermi paradox further states that many of these intelligent life forms may have set out on interstellar explorations. This means establishing contact with extraterrestrial life should prove fruitful at some point of time or the other.

The question, though, remains. Whether such extraterrestrial life would have the means to receive our message or not. This has remained a major thorn in our quest for extraterrestrial life, leading to questioning whether the TRAPPIST-1 system is too young, or maybe too old in accordance to its star, to support intelligent life forms.

"Mankind was born on Earth, it was never meant to die here"

Taking a leaf out of Christopher Nolan's screenplay, it is not too wrong to be optimistic on the TRAPPIST-1 system. It is, after all, the most striking discovery of Earth-like planets.

Much work and studies still remain, and so do a number of questions surrounding our sudden flux of interest in discovering extraterrestrial life. The likes of Elon Musk are taking to the skies to begin space tourism, and even aiming for Mars to spread out mankind's arm of



What mysteries would these planets behold?

would have planets that lie in the habitable zone, exhibiting Earth-like qualities. In turn, at least some of them would run high probabilities of developing intelligent life forms.

This would place our Solar system as one of the many intelligent life-support-

evolution. Will we stumble upon intelligent life in our near future, or are we actually all alone in the vast universe? Much of these answers may lie within the confines of TRAPPIST-1.

Mankind was certainly born on Earth, but was it really not meant to die here?